

The Daily Courant.

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In the 1600s, England had no daily newspapers because the government controlled printing and made newspapers expensive through taxes.

The first British daily newspaper, the Daily Courant, was published on 11 March 1702 by Edward and Elizabeth Mallet. It printed foreign news and advertisements but avoided British news and opinions to stay out of trouble with the government.

In 1703, Samuel Buckley bought the paper. Although he was fined in 1712 for printing a report about Parliament, the publicity helped increase sales. The Daily Courant lasted for 34 years before merging with another newspaper in 1735.

This page also includes a picture of a plaque marking the site of the Daily Courant in Little Britain.



Blue plaque near Little Britain; photo Victor Grigas